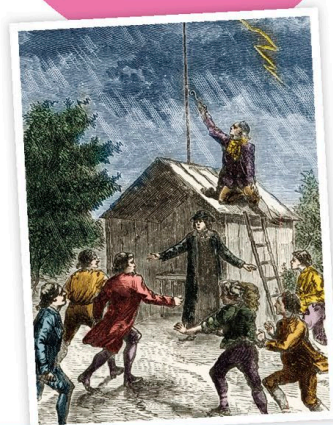


May

10



1752

Sparks in the sky

French scientist Thomas François Dalibard drew sparks from a thunderstorm with a 15 m (50 ft) iron rod raised towards the clouds near Paris, France. The experiment demonstrated that lightning is a form of electricity.

Born this day

1960 Merlene Ottey, Jamaican-Slovenian athlete. A track and field sprinter, she competed in every Summer Olympics from 1980 to 2004.

1869

The golden spike

A spike made of 18 carat gold was driven into a railway track in Utah, USA, to mark the completion of the USA's first transcontinental railroad. The track connected Sacramento in the west with Omaha in the east.



War leader

1940

Winston Churchill replaced Neville Chamberlain as the United Kingdom's prime minister. Churchill led the country through World War II and played a major role in the Allied victory.

Also on this day

1857 Indian troops began an unsuccessful revolt against the British in the First War of Independence.

1933 Student groups supporting the Nazi regime burned books by Jewish and liberal writers, claiming the books were "un-German".

1994 Following a historic election victory, Nelson Mandela became South Africa's first Black president.